

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

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Record Tanker Attacks Choke the Strait of Hormuz

- Attacks on tankers in and around the Strait of Hormuz hit their highest weekly level of the eight-month war, maritime-security sources told Reuters: UKMTO logged nine attacks in the first seven days of October alone — half of all of September — and Kpler data showed ten tankers struck between September 28 and October 4, well above the prior weekly high of six. — [Reuters](#)
- In the latest strike, a tanker 51 nautical miles north of Qatar's Madinat ash Shamal was hit by multiple projectiles Wednesday with casualties reported, UKMTO said — the first deep-Gulf attack in nearly a month. — [Reuters](#)
- Just seven tankers transited the strait on Tuesday — less than half the seven-day average and the lowest since July 23, per Kpler data cited by Reuters and CNN; ten crossed on Wednesday. — [Reuters](#)
- Brent crude rose 4.3 percent to \$104.48 a barrel early Thursday and WTI gained about 4.3 percent to \$92.05, CNN reported; Hurricane Isais is heading for the U.S. Gulf refining hub, and Shell and Chevron said they would curtail production and evacuate nonessential personnel. — [CNN](#)
- ICE gasoil jumped 6 percent Wednesday after the IEA said it would not add oil beyond the 400-million-barrel March release, CNN reported; Gulf stock markets fell in early Thursday trade — Saudi Arabia, Abu Dhabi and Dubai each down 0.9 percent, Qatar down 0.6 percent. — [Reuters](#)

Syria Weighs Joining the Yemen War

- Syria is carefully considering military support against Yemen's Houthis — ranging from defensive aid for Saudi Arabia to an offensive deployment alongside Saudi-backed Yemeni troops — a U.S. official and a Syrian defense official told Reuters. — [Reuters](#)
- Saudi Arabia has pushed allied nations including Turkey and Pakistan for support, made more urgent by this week's deadly airport attacks, Reuters reported. — [Reuters](#)
- A succession of loud booms was heard in Riyadh on Thursday morning which Reuters could not identify; there was no official comment and no public early-warning alerts, though some diplomats received warnings and some Riyadh schools told parents to shelter in place. — [Reuters](#)
- The Houthis said Thursday they had attacked Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport with a ballistic missile; Saudi government media did not immediately respond — unconfirmed. — [Reuters](#)

Saudi Coalition Destroys Sana'a Launcher; Missiles Land Near Aden Airport

- Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Maliki said Saudi forces destroyed the ballistic-missile launcher in Sana'a used in the Riyadh airport attack, adding preparations were underway for 'another imminent attack.' — [CNN](#)
- Houthi missiles landed near Aden airport's runway shortly before a Yemenia Airways flight from Cairo was due to land, forcing it to divert to Jeddah, Yemen's transport ministry said Wednesday. — [CNN](#)

- The death toll from the two airport strikes is confirmed at three — a Sudanese resident killed at Riyadh's King Khalid airport and Moroccan and Algerian women killed at Abha — with 36 wounded, Saudi officials confirmed. — [WSJ](#)
- Two Saudi officials told the Wall Street Journal the Houthis have used missiles to target Saudi airports all week; Saudi officials warned Tuesday that filming or sharing images of drone and missile attacks could bring legal charges. — [WSJ](#)
- On Wednesday the U.S. Mission in Saudi Arabia issued an updated security alert citing Houthi public threats against airports and airspace — warning of potential flight cancellations and airspace closures, and barring U.S. government employees from travel within 20 miles of the Yemen border and to several cities without authorization. — [CNN](#)

Pakistan Deploys Under Mecca Pact Without Parliament's Vote

- Eleven years after parliament voted to keep Pakistan out of the Saudi-led Yemen intervention, Islamabad has agreed to rapidly deploy more forces to Saudi Arabia without a parliamentary vote — underscoring the military's grip on foreign policy under Field Marshal Asim Munir, Reuters reported. — [Reuters](#)
- Pakistan's information ministry said the alliance 'has gone through all necessary government procedures' but would not say whether cabinet or parliament was involved, calling details 'a matter of operational confidentiality.' — [Reuters](#)
- Constitutional changes last year put Munir in command of all three services until 2030 with lifetime field-marshal rank and immunity; Reuters notes it is unclear whether Pakistani troops will fight the Houthis directly — which could rupture Pakistan's active mediator role between Washington and Tehran. — [Reuters](#)
- Pakistan's military media chief Lt. Gen. Ahmed Sharif Chaudhry told CNN that Pakistani forces are already stationed in Saudi Arabia, declining to specify numbers or capabilities as classified. — [CNN](#)

Trump Stirs Row With Iran-Attack Remarks

- At an October 5 campaign rally in Grand Island, Nebraska, President Trump said Iran could 'take out' Los Angeles or San Diego as a 'very small price to pay' for keeping the country safe; he said the U.S. is 'kicking Iran's ass' and predicted the war 'will be over with very soon.' — [CNN](#)
- White House communications director Steven Cheung said on X that Trump was describing the threat a nuclear-armed Iran would have posed, not endorsing an attack; Gov. Gavin Newsom called the remarks 'deranged and dangerous' and Los Angeles mayor Karen Bass said they 'could potentially compromise our safety.' — [CNN](#)
- On October 6 Trump said 'nobody knows who the hell is running the country' in Iran, citing killed leaders; Iranian foreign ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei said Washington knows its counterpart and blamed 'contradictory positions and mixed messaging from U.S. officials.' — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent crude settled at \$105.15 a barrel on October 8 (ICE front-month futures); Reuters' October 8 energy wire reports the same-day supply-concern rally amid the Hormuz tanker attacks. — [Reuters](#)

- WTI crude settled at \$92.68 a barrel on October 8 (NYMEX front-month futures); Reuters' October 8 energy wire reports the same-day rally. — [Reuters](#)
- U.S. diesel prices jumped alongside oil on the tanker attacks (CNN, October 8); the EIA weekly national average stands at \$6.199 a gallon for the week ending October 5. — [CNN](#)
- UK NBP day-ahead natural gas settled at 186.755 pence per therm for October 7 (EEX); European gas prices jumped on the attacks (CNN, October 8). — [CNN](#)
- The U.S. 10-year Treasury yield settled at 5.28 percent on October 7, after a strong \$39 billion 10-year note auction drew the highest auction yield since November 2000, per the Wall Street Journal's market coverage. — [WSJ](#)

Shipping

- Seven commodity vessels transited the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday — less than half the seven-day average and the lowest since July 23 — and ten crossed on Wednesday; more vessels entered than exited over the two days, with AIS-dark vessels excluded (Kpler and LSEG data, via Reuters). — [Reuters](#)
- Crude crossing the strait fell 27 percent from its wartime high to at least 10.1 million barrels a day — back to the September average, 74 percent of the pre-war level (Kpler analysts, via Reuters). — [Reuters](#)

Conflict map



Markers show reported strike sites, bases, and shipping areas. Purple polygons mark approximate or announced closure / exclusion zones.

Related media

Crude oil tanker transiting the Strait of Hormuz (illustrative) — [view original](#)



Tankers in the Strait of Hormuz (illustrative) — [view original](#)

Saudi–Pakistani military cooperation (file photo) — [view original](#)

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